

Figure 1.16 *The Buddhist site of Tapa Sardar, Ghazni, Afghanistan, third–ninth century* CE*: upper terrace, star-shaped stupa (eighth century). F. Bonardi, neg. 7410–9. © Italian Archaeological Mission in Afghanistan, 1968.*

place of Ghaznavid ascendancy. The rarity of Ghazna's stellate *minar*s, and yet their proximity to such a prominent monastic establishment, renders Buddhist precedents that much more plausible. The Yamini–Ghaznavids, then, adapted to and even capitalized upon the cultural landscape *they* inherited, to create distinct interpretations of the Persianate world's cosmopolitan architectural cultures.

Notwithstanding the differences in geographical scale mentioned before, a further resonance between the Saljuqs and the Shansabanis is worth highlighting: the Saljuqs' disconcertingly rapid and thorough permeation of the Persianate lands and Anatolia – and ultimately even the very heart of caliphal authority in Baghdad by the mid-eleventh century – forms an intriguing parallel to the profound and reverberating effects of the Shansabanis' eastward campaigns deep into the north Indian *duab* during the last decade of the twelfth century. As noted in the Introduction and argued in detail in Volume II, it was the Shansabanis' politico-military and